SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #15 · DEBT AND SHAME

"Talking about money is shameful."

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Where it often comes from

In many families, money was never discussed, or it was discussed only in anger. Phrases like "Don't ask what people earn" or "That is none of your business" can grow into the belief that any talk about money is improper. For some, church or culture added the idea that money is spiritually unclean. The result is people who cannot ask questions, plan with a spouse, or seek help.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture speaks about money openly. Jesus talked about it often, and Proverbs urges us to know the state of our flocks and pay close attention to our herds. Jesus said that anyone who wants to build a tower should first sit down and count the cost. Proverbs says that the wise listen to counsel. Honest conversation about money is not shameful; it is part of stewardship, love, and wisdom, and the psalmist says that those who look to the Lord are radiant with joy and their faces will never be ashamed.

> *"Which of you, wishing to build a tower, does not first sit down and count the cost to see if he has the resources to complete it?"* (Luke 14:28).

Also see

> "Be sure to know the state of your flocks, and pay close attention to your herds" (Proverbs 27:23).
>
> "The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel" (Proverbs 12:15).
>
> "For lack of guidance, a nation falls, but with many counselors comes deliverance" (Proverbs 11:14).
>
> "Those who look to Him are radiant with joy; their faces shall never be ashamed" (Psalm 34:5).

Common self-statements

- Money is not something decent people talk about.
- Asking about money is rude.
- If I bring it up, I will look greedy.
- My spouse and I should not argue about money, so we do not talk.
- I would rather not know.
- It is not spiritual to care about money.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Believing I should never discuss money.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling uncomfortable and concluding that it is wrong.
- Avoidance: Staying away from the topic so I do not have to feel the discomfort.
- Mind reading: Assuming others would think badly of me for asking.

Challenging questions

- What did I learn about discussing money growing up?
- What has my silence cost me or my family?

- What would it look like to talk about money kindly and clearly?
- What does Jesus say about counting the cost?
- Who could I practice with first?
- What question about money have I been afraid to ask?

Truth summary

> Talking about money honestly is a form of wisdom and love. I can learn to speak clearly and kindly, ask questions, and plan together with others. Shame is not required, and God's people are not covered with shame.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Money
- Wisdom
- Communication
- Guidance
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Talking about money is shameful"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Talking about money is shameful." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I learn about money talk growing up?
- ☐ What has silence cost me?
- ☐ What question have I been afraid to ask?
- ☐ Who could I talk with first?
- ☐ What would a calm money conversation sound like?
- ☐ What does Jesus say about counting the cost?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Talking about money is part of wise stewardship.
- ☐ Counting the cost is biblical.
- ☐ Silence is not the same as peace.
- ☐ I can speak about money kindly and clearly.
- ☐ Questions are not rude.
- ☐ I do not have to feel shame to be careful.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 14:28**
  "Which of you, wishing to build a tower, does not first sit down and count the cost to see if he has the resources to complete it?"
- ☐ **Proverbs 27:23**
  "Be sure to know the state of your flocks, and pay close attention to your herds."
- ☐ **Psalm 34:5**
  "Those who look to Him are radiant with joy; their faces shall never be ashamed."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A money conversation: Each week, note one conversation about money, with whom, and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 14:28 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Counting the cost is wise, so I can talk about money without shame.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write down one question. What do you most want to understand about your finances?
- [ ] Schedule a calm talk. If you have a spouse or family member, set a time with no distractions and an agreed ending time.
- [ ] Use simple words. Practice a sentence such as, "I would like us to look at our budget together so we can plan."
- [ ] Ask a professional. If needed, meet with a nonprofit counselor or advisor and bring your questions.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Talking about money is shameful": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A money conversation
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Talking about money is shameful.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You are not ashamed of me, and You care about every part of my life, including money. Free me from shame about this subject. Give me words to speak kindly and clearly, and wisdom to plan well. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.